



RIL plans global push with indigenous 5G technology

Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) chairman Mukesh Ambani has announced the development of a made-in-India 5G technology solution that will help create a connected digital ecosystem, spanning telecom, e-commerce, retail and enterprise solutions in India and outside. The trials will be conducted next year when 5G spectrum becomes available.

“Once Jio’s 5G solution is proven at India-scale, Jio platforms would be well-positioned to be an exporter of 5G solutions to other telecom operators globally, as a complete managed service,” says Ambani.

The technology is being built indigenously by an in-house technical team at Jio Platforms, the company’s digital business arm. He further adds that one of the key focus areas of Jio will be to upgrade millions of Indians

using feature phones on 2G networks by offering them cheap smartphones. “As India is standing at the doorsteps of the 5G era, we should accelerate the migration of 350 million Indians, who currently use a 2G feature phone, to an affordable smartphone,” Ambani adds.

The search engine giant Google will invest 337.37 billion rupees in Jio Platforms for a 7.73 per cent stake. With Google as a partner, Ambani says RIL is looking to design an entry-level 4G or even a 5G smartphone at a price that could be a fraction of the current cost. The move may set to hit China’s Huawei’s 5G plans in India amid the already heightened India-China tensions.

Analysts say that Jio’s move to develop its own 5G technology is aimed at reducing dependence on foreign vendors and cost-related advantages.

Automotive power electronics market to reach \$4.7 billion by 2025

The automotive power electronics market is expected to grow from 3.8 billion dollars in 2020 to 4.7 billion dollars by 2025 at a CAGR of 4.7 per cent, as per a report by MarketsandMarkets.

The report says that increasing electronics content inside a vehicle, government mandates related to carbon emissions, and vehicle safety are crucial factors that will fuel the market growth. Development in the power converters of an electric vehicle (EV) is another factor that will drive the automotive power electronics market.

The report says, “Vehicle production was low in April and May 2020 in the major European, Asia Pacific countries and the US due to

the ongoing Covid-19 pandemic. As vehicle production is suspended, any new investment for advanced technology is unlikely. OEMs and tier 1 players are either using cash reserves or acquiring funds to continue operations during the crisis. OEMs are still skeptical about the recovery of vehicle sales to 2019 levels in 2020.”

As per the report, the increasing use of mechatronics devices and comfort features inside the vehicle is expected to result in the dominance of body control and comfort segment in the automotive power electronics market. Body control and comfort comprise features like tire pressure monitoring system (TPMS), lighting, seat control, heating, ventilation

ON THE move



TEMA appoints chairman and vice-chairman

Telecom Equipment Manufacturers Association (TEMA) has announced the appointment of Ravi Sharma as its chairman and Sandeep Aggarwal as vice-chairman. Ravi Sharma, a distinguished alumnus of IIT Roorkee, has previously worked as CEO of Alcatel South Asia, Videocon Telecom, and Adani Power Ltd. He is also the President of the IIT Alumni Council, an autonomous global body of alumni of all the twenty-three IITs.

Sandeep Aggarwal is chairman and managing director of Paramount Group of Companies and chairman of the PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry’s telecom committee. He is also co-chairman of the Telecom Export and Services Export Promotion Council.

Roshni Nadar named chairperson of HCL Technologies

Roshni Nadar has been named chairperson of HCL Technologies, the Noida-based IT company. The 38-year-old succeeds her father, Shiv Nadar. She has become the first woman to head an Indian publicly traded software firm.

She joined HCL Corporation in 2009, and within a year of joining she was promoted to the post of executive director and CEO. She came on the board of HCL Technologies in 2013 as vice-chairperson. Roshni will continue as CEO of HCL Corporation, the holding company for all the group entities.

Before joining HCL Corporation, she worked with Sky News UK and CNN America as a news producer.

and air-conditioning (HVAC) and start-stop module. Vehicles globally are getting installed with the latest versions of these sub-applications of body control and comfort. The report says that the start-stop module sub-application is showing good growth in recent years. The vehicles are getting installed with modern LED technologies for both interior and exterior lighting.